



Aetherbound

A Starbound Modlist Guide

Starbound 1.4.4 · v1.0

Mod Manager: SBMM by korsir

Contents

Contents	2
About This Guide	3
Installation Guide	5
Wave 0: First Steps	9
How to Play Starbound	11
Wave 0 Modlist	17
Wave 1: Beyond the Horizon	19
Advanced Strategy	21
Wave 1 Modlist	24

About This Guide

Welcome to **Aetherbound**, a curated modlist guide for Starbound 1.4.4. Whether stepping off your ship for the first time or returning after saving the universe, this guide has something for you.

How It Works

Aetherbound is organized into two **waves**. Each is a self-contained game setup: its own roleplaying backstory, its own mod set, and a guide tuned to your experience level. Start with Wave 0, finish the game, then return for Wave 1.

CONCEPT A **wave** bundles a specific set of mods, a narrative role to play, and guidance matched to your experience. Nothing carries over between waves — each is a fresh start.

Wave Overview

Wave 0: First Steps

Fresh Protectorate academy graduate on your first assignment. This wave assumes zero prior Starbound experience. Includes a complete how-to-play walkthrough. Mods are limited to quality-of-life and bugfixes — nothing that changes core gameplay.

- **Categories:** QoL and UI, Bugfixes
- **Experience required:** None
- **Goal:** Learn Starbound from scratch with a polished vanilla experience

Wave 1: Beyond the Horizon

Veteran protector reassigned to fringe space. You have beaten the Ruin and know the galaxy. This wave adds new races, quests, planets, mechanics, ships, weapons, and visual enhancements. The strategy guide covers advanced topics.

- **Categories:** Graphics, Races, Content, Mechanics, Ships, Weapons and Armor, Building, Audio, Adult
- **Experience required:** Completed vanilla story at least once
- **Goal:** Deepen and expand Starbound with carefully selected mods

Mod Selection Philosophy

Every mod in Aetherbound passes a strict filter:

- **Compatible:** Works with Starbound 1.4.x. No exceptions.
- **Non-cheating:** No god-mode items, free resources, or all-knowing UI panels.
- **Non-redundant:** When two mods do the same thing, we pick the better one.
- **Non-conflicting:** No mod pair breaks each other. Documented when unavoidable.
- **Appropriate:** Adult content is tasteful and relevant. No porn.

TIP Each mod entry includes a clickable Steam Workshop link, dependency list, and SBMM-specific install notes. You are expected to install mods yourself — this guide tells you what to get and how to set it up.

Prerequisites

Before you begin:

- Starbound 1.4.4 installed via Steam
- SBMM (Starbound Mod Manager) by korsir — download from GitHub
- About 30 minutes for initial setup

Installation Guide

This chapter walks you through setting up SBMM (Starbound Mod Manager), preparing your game, and installing mods for both waves.

Step 1: Install SBMM

SBMM is a mod manager for Starbound created by **korsir**. It handles mod profiles, load order, conflict detection, and Workshop integration.

Download SBMM from its GitHub repository: [SBMM on GitHub](#)

Extract the archive to a folder of your choice (e.g., `C:\Tools\SBMM`). Run `SBMM.exe` to launch.

TIP Create a desktop shortcut to `SBMM.exe` — you will be using it frequently.

Step 2: Configure SBMM

First Launch

On first launch, SBMM will ask you to locate your Starbound installation. Point it to your Steam Starbound folder (usually `C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\steamapps\common\Starbound`).

Create Profiles

SBMM uses **profiles** to separate mod sets. Create two profiles:

1. **Aetherbound — Wave 0** — for your first playthrough
2. **Aetherbound — Wave 1** — for your second playthrough

CONCEPT Profiles let you switch between completely different mod setups without uninstalling anything. Wave 0 and Wave 1 are independent — nothing carries over between them.

Set Up Mod Groups

Within each profile, create **groups** (folder-like categories) matching the modlist structure:

Wave 0 groups: 00-QoL-UI, 01-Bugfixes

Wave 1 groups: 01-Graphics, 02-Races, 03-Content, 04-Mechanics, 05-Ships, 06-Weapons-Armor, 07-Building, 08-Audio, 09-Adult

Place mods into their corresponding group as you install them. This keeps your load order organized and makes troubleshooting easier.

Step 3: Workshop Backup Strategy

Steam Workshop auto-updates mods, which can break your carefully tested setup at any time. To prevent this:

1. Subscribe to all mods for your current wave on Steam Workshop
2. Wait for Steam to download them (check the Downloads page)
3. Navigate to your Workshop content folder: `Steam\steamapps\workshop\content\211820\`
4. Copy the entire 211820 folder to a safe location (e.g., `C:\StarboundMods\Wave0\`)
5. In SBMM, configure the profile to use this **backup** folder — not the live Workshop folder

WARNING Always back up your Workshop mods before starting a playthrough. If a mod updates mid-game and breaks your save, you can restore from the backup. SBMM cannot roll back Workshop updates.

Repeat this process for each wave. Your backup folders are frozen snapshots of a known-good mod set.

Step 4: Install Mods

For each mod in the guide:

1. Click the mod name (it links to the Steam Workshop page)
2. Click **Subscribe** on the Workshop page
3. Wait for Steam to download it
4. In SBMM, refresh your mod list — the new mod should appear
5. Drag it into the correct group
6. Check the install notes in the mod entry for any special instructions

TIP Install mods in the order they appear within each category. This follows the recommended load order and minimizes conflicts.

Step 5: Verify Your Setup

Before starting a playthrough:

- In SBMM, run the conflict checker. Resolve any flagged conflicts (check `conflicts.md` for guidance).
- Launch Starbound through SBMM (not directly through Steam).
- Start a new game. Confirm the main menu loads without errors.

- Complete the intro mission. Confirm no crashes or missing assets.

If something goes wrong, disable mods in groups (starting from the last group) until you identify the problem mod.

Switching Waves

When you are ready to move from Wave 0 to Wave 1:

1. Back up your Wave 0 save if you want to keep it
2. Switch to the **Aetherbound — Wave 1** profile in SBMM
3. Repeat the Workshop backup process for Wave 1 mods
4. Start a new game — Wave 1 is a fresh playthrough

WARNING Do not load a Wave 0 save with Wave 1 mods enabled. Adding content mods to an existing save can cause crashes, missing items, or corrupted worlds. Always start fresh for a new wave.

Wave 0

First Steps

Fresh Protectorate academy graduate.
First planetary posting.
Wide-eyed explorer armed with a basic
Matter Manipulator and academy training,
setting out into the unknown.

Wave 0: First Steps

Your Story

You are **Cadet [Name]**, top of your class at the Terrene Protectorate Academy. Six years of training. Thousands of simulations. Countless hours in the Matter Manipulator certification lab. None of it prepared you for this.

The assignment came through this morning — a standard graduation posting to a Protectorate outpost in the Epsilon Sector. Routine. Safe. The kind of assignment every new graduate gets. Your duffel is packed. Your Matter Manipulator is freshly calibrated. Your shuttle leaves in twenty minutes.

You take one last look at the academy grounds — the spires of Earth's last great institution silhouetted against a pale morning sky — and you cannot shake the feeling that nothing will be routine about this.

Setting the Tone

Wave 0 is about **discovery**. You are learning everything for the first time — how to survive on alien worlds, how to build, how to fight. The universe is vast and indifferent, but it is also beautiful. Every planet is a new mystery. Every ruin holds a story.

Play at your own pace. Read every codex entry. Build that unnecessary balcony on your ship. The story will wait.

CONCEPT Roleplaying tip: Keep an in-character journal. Write a few lines after each session about what your cadet discovered, who they met, and how they feel about their first real assignment. It adds surprising depth to the experience.

Wave 0 Mod Loadout

Only two categories of mods are active in this wave:

- **QoL and UI** — Improvements to inventory management, the SAIL interface, and the starmap. No new items. No balance changes. Just a smoother experience.
- **Bugfixes** — Community patches for known issues in Starbound 1.4.4 that were never officially fixed.

TIP If you are tempted to add more mods, resist. Wave 0 is about experiencing Starbound as it was designed. Wave 1 will give you all the content you crave.

How to Play Starbound

This chapter is a focused walkthrough for new players. It covers everything you need to get from the intro mission through the main story. It is not a comprehensive wiki — for detailed item stats and mechanics, the official Starbound Wiki is your companion.

Controls and Interface

Basic Controls

| Key | Action | |——|——| | A / D | Move left / right | | Space | Jump | | S | Crouch / drop through platforms | | Left click | Use Matter Manipulator / attack | | Right click | Secondary ability (weapon-dependent) | | R | Switch Matter Manipulator mode | | E | Interact (open doors, talk, loot) | | I | Open inventory | | C | Open crafting menu | | J | Open quest journal | | Tab | Toggle hotbar | | 1-6 | Hotbar slots | | Esc | Pause / main menu |

TIP Press R to quickly cycle between Matter Manipulator modes: mine, paint, wire, and scan. You will use mining mode 90% of the time.

The HUD

- **Top-left:** Health bar (red) and Energy bar (green). Energy recharges automatically. Health requires bandages, salves, or beds.
- **Top-center:** Hotbar — your 6 active items. Left and right slots are for two-handed dual-wielding.
- **Top-right:** Current planet name, weather indicators, and status effects.
- **Bottom-left:** Chat and system messages.

Your First Hour

The Intro Mission

You start aboard a Protectorate ship. Follow the on-screen prompts — they teach you the basics of movement and interaction. The intro mission is linear and unskippable on a first playthrough.

Key moments:

- **Matter Manipulator:** You receive it from the locker. This is your most important tool.
- **Combat tutorial:** You will fight basic enemies with a sword. Left click to swing.

- **The emergency:** Something goes wrong. Follow the prompts. You cannot die during the intro.
- **Escape:** You will board a shuttle. This is a cutscene. Watch it — it sets up the entire story.

Your First Planet

After the intro, you crash-land on a procedurally generated **Lush** planet. This is your first real taste of Starbound.

CONCEPT Procedural generation: Every planet in Starbound is generated by an algorithm. Two players on a “Lush” planet will see different landscapes, different dungeons, and different NPCs. Your journey is uniquely yours.

What to do first:

1. Follow the initial quest prompts from SAIL (your ship’s AI)
2. Gather basic resources: **Wood** from trees, **Cobblestone** from the ground
3. Craft a **Crafting Table** from your ship’s basic crafting menu (press C)
4. Craft **Wooden Platforms** — you will need them for climbing
5. Explore the surface. Look for chests, NPC camps, and cave entrances

TIP Hold Shift to place blocks in a 1x1 grid instead of the default 2x2 mining mode. This is essential for precise building and bridging across gaps.

Your First Cave

Caves are where you find **Core Fragments** — a critical early-game resource needed to power your ship and activate the FTL drive.

1. Craft **Torches** from Wood and Coal
2. Find a cave entrance (dark hole in the ground) or dig down
3. Place torches as you go — enemies spawn in darkness
4. Look for glowing red ore: **Core Fragments**
5. You need 20 Core Fragments to activate the FTL drive

WARNING Caves get dangerous at night and at deeper levels. Craft a basic weapon and some **Salves** (from Plant Fibre) before venturing too deep. If you die, you drop items — but you can recover them by returning to the spot.

Activating the FTL Drive

Return to your ship with 20 Core Fragments. Interact with the FTL drive console (center of the ship) to activate it. This unlocks interstellar travel — congratulations, you are no longer stranded.

Core Survival Systems

Hunger

You have a hunger meter (visible in the inventory screen, top-left). It drains slowly over time. Eating food restores it.

- **Cooked food** restores more hunger than raw ingredients
- Craft a **Campfire** (10 Wood + 1 Torch) to cook meat and produce
- Plant **crops** on your ship or a planet base for a renewable food supply
- If your hunger bar empties, you start taking damage

CONCEPT Different foods provide different buffs — increased health, energy regen, speed, and more. Experiment with cooking recipes. A well-fed explorer is a surviving explorer.

Temperature

On some planets, temperature is lethal:

- **Cold planets:** You will see a freezing status effect. Craft **Campfires** or **Torches** and stand near them to warm up.
- **Hot/Radioactive planets:** You take damage without protection. Craft **Breathing EPP** upgrades at an Anvil.
- **Planets without atmosphere:** You take suffocation damage. Wear a **Breathing EPP**.

Death and Recovery

When you die, you drop a portion of your **Pixels** (currency) and some items at your death location. You respawn on your ship.

- **On Normal difficulty:** You drop 30% of your pixels and some items. You can recover them.
- **On Survival difficulty:** You drop items and must eat to survive. Food is scarce.
- **On Hardcore difficulty:** Permanent death. Your character is deleted.

TIP For your first playthrough, choose **Normal** difficulty. Survival and Hardcore add significant challenge that is more enjoyable once you understand the game's systems.

Tech and Progression

Story Missions

The main story is accessed through SAIL on your ship. Missions are planetary instances — you beam down to a special dungeon and cannot leave until you complete or fail the objective.

Mission order (approximate):

1. **Erchius Mining Facility** — Unlocks FTL travel to other systems
2. **Scan floran artifacts** — Unlocks the Floran artifact mission
3. **Ceremonial Hunting Caverns** (Floran) — First boss: Ixodoom
4. **Scan hylotl artifacts** — Unlocks Hylotl artifact mission
5. **Grand Pagoda Library** (Hylotl) — Boss: Asra Nox appears
6. **Scan avian artifacts** — Unlocks Avian artifact mission
7. **Great Sovereign Temple** (Avian) — Boss: Kluex Avatar
8. **Scan apex artifacts** — Unlocks Apex artifact mission
9. **Miniknog Stronghold** (Apex) — Boss: Big Ape
10. **Scan glitch artifacts** — Unlocks Glitch artifact mission
11. **Baron's Keep** (Glitch) — Boss: Bone Dragon
12. **The Ruin** — Final boss: The Ruin (Heart of the Ruin)

TIP Between missions, explore new planet types, upgrade your gear, and recruit crew members. The story is not a race — it is the backdrop for your exploration.

Matter Manipulator Upgrades

Your Matter Manipulator improves as you progress:

- **Base:** 2x2 mining area, slow speed
- **Upgrade 1:** 3x3 mining area (requires Manipulator Modules)
- **Upgrade 2:** 4x4 mining area, faster speed
- **Upgrade 3:** 5x5 mining area, liquid collection

Find **Manipulator Modules** in chests, as quest rewards, and from merchants.

Techs

Techs are abilities you equip at a **Tech Console** on your ship. You unlock slots by completing story missions.

Key tech types:

- **Movement:** Dash, Sprint, Pulse Jump, Air Dash
- **Body:** Distortion Sphere (roll through small gaps), Spike Sphere (climb walls)
- **Head:** Light (illuminates area), Oxygen (underwater breathing)

CONCEPT Techs are game-changers. Dash + Pulse Jump makes exploration dramatically faster. Prioritize unlocking these two as early as possible.

Crafting and Gear Progression

Crafting Stations

| Station | Requires | Produces | |———|———|———| | Basic Crafting (C key) | Nothing |
 Torches, platforms, campfire | | Inventor's Table | Crafting Table | Basic tools, weapons, armor
 | | Spinning Wheel | Inventor's Table | Fabric, bandages | | Anvil | Inventor's Table | Metal armor,
 weapons, EPPs | | Forge | Anvil | Advanced metal gear | | Replicator | Forge | Endgame gear |
 | Separator's Table | Replicator | Perfect-tier gear |

Ore Tiers

| Tier | Ore | Found On | Armor Set | |——|——|———|———| | 1 | Iron | Lush, Forest | Iron
 Armor | | 2 | Tungsten | Desert, Savannah | Tungsten Armor | | 3 | Titanium | Ocean, Jungle |
 Titanium Armor | | 4 | Durasteel | Toxic, Mutated | Durasteel Armor | | 5 | Aegisalt / Ferozium /
 Violium | Frozen, Fiery, Radioactive | Racial Armor | | 6 | Solarium | Fiery, Volcanic | Solarium
 Armor |

TIP Always upgrade your armor before tackling a new tier of planets. The damage reduction difference between tiers is substantial. A Tungsten set on a Tier 4 planet will get you killed in seconds.

EPPs (Environmental Protection Packs)

EPPs are back-slot equipment that protect against planetary hazards:

- **Breathing EPP:** Survive on airless planets and moons
- **Radiation EPP:** Survive on radioactive planets
- **Heating EPP:** Survive on frozen planets
- **Cooling EPP:** Survive on fiery planets

Craft EPP upgrades at an Anvil or Forge. Higher-tier EPPs combine multiple protections.

Crew and Colony

Recruiting Crew

NPCs in settlements sometimes offer to join your crew after you complete a quest for them. Crew members provide:

- **Engineers:** Increase ship fuel efficiency
- **Soldiers:** Follow and fight with you on planets
- **Medics:** Regenerate your health
- **Mechanics:** Increase ship speed
- **Janitors:** Slightly improve various ship functions
- **Tailors:** Change your crew's uniform colors

CONCEPT A full crew of 12 members provides significant passive bonuses. Recruit actively — every NPC you help might join you, and the ship feels alive with a full complement.

Colony Building

Deploy a **Colony Deed** on a planet to establish a colony. Place furnished rooms with appropriate items to attract specific tenant types. Tenants pay rent (pixels or items) and may offer quests.

Colony requirements:

- Enclosed room with background walls
- Door
- Light source
- At least one piece of furniture

Attract specific tenants by placing themed furniture. A **Cooking Table** attracts a chef. A **Weapon Rack** attracts a guard.

Farming

Craft a **Wooden Hoe** to till soil. Plant seeds (found while exploring). Water crops by building near a water source or using a **Sprinkler** (crafted later).

- **Staple crops:** Wheat, Rice, Potato — reliable hunger fillers
- **Cash crops:** Boneboo, Neonmelon — sell for high pixel value
- **Utility crops:** Cotton — makes fabric for bandages and armor

TIP Build a farm on your ship. The ship is always loaded while you are on it, so crops grow passively as you travel. A medium ship farm can make hunger management trivial.

Mechs

Unlocked after completing the **Dr. Akaggy's** introductory quest (triggers after a few story missions). Mechs are large exosuits for space and planet exploration.

- Mechs can operate on **space encounters** (anomalies, asteroids, enemy ships)
- Upgrade mech parts at a **Mech Assembly Station**
- Mechs use Energy instead of Health
- Mechs cannot be used inside story mission instances

Bounty Hunting

After the main story, visit any **Peacekeeper Station** to begin bounty hunting. Bounties are procedurally generated missions with unique targets and rewards. A good post-game activity that sends you to planets you might not otherwise visit.

Wave 0 Modlist

Quality of Life & UI

Mods go here.

Bugfixes

Mods go here.

Wave 1

Beyond the Horizon

Veteran protector reassigned to fringe space.
Deeper mysteries await beyond charted territory.
Seasoned explorer with resources, reputation,
and the honed instinct that only comes from
surviving the unknown.

Wave 1: Beyond the Horizon

Your Story

Commander [Name]. That is what the dossier says now. Five years since the academy. Three sector assignments. One confirmed Ruin-class entity neutralized. Your service record is spotless, and Earth Command has noticed.

The new posting came encrypted — triple-sealed, Protectorate Priority Black. **Kappa Sector.** Fringe space. The kind of region where colony transponders go dark and patrol ships do not come back.

Your briefing was short: investigate anomalous readings near the Rim. Standard recon. But the coordinates match a set of ruins the Protectorate has been quietly tracking for decades — structures that predate every known civilization.

You have a new ship. A handpicked crew. A Matter Manipulator upgraded beyond academy specs. And a gnawing certainty that the Protectorate is not telling you everything.

Beyond the horizon, the real story begins.

Setting the Tone

Wave 1 is about **mastery and mystery**. You know how to survive. Now you learn how to thrive — and you peel back the layers of a universe that is stranger and deeper than the academy ever taught.

Play with confidence. Push into dangerous territory. The mods in this wave add entire civilizations, new technology trees, and systems that make the galaxy feel alive in ways vanilla only hinted at.

CONCEPT Roleplaying tip: Keep your journal from Wave 0. Read back through it occasionally. The contrast between your cadet self and your commander self tells its own story. What would Cadet you think of the places Commander you now treads without hesitation?

Wave 1 Mod Loadout

Nine categories of mods are active in this wave:

- **Graphics** — Enhanced visuals, parallax layers, planetary backgrounds, lighting
- **Races** — New playable species with custom ships, armor, and dialogue
- **Content** — Quests, planets, biomes, dungeons, and NPCs

- **Mechanics** — New techs, crafting chains, and survival systems
- **Ships** — Expanded ship building, custom SAIL interfaces, crew enhancements
- **Weapons and Armor** — New weapon types, armor sets, and procedural generation upgrades
- **Building** — Furniture packs, block sets, and colony expansions
- **Audio** — Music packs and ambient soundscapes
- **Adult** — Tasteful mature content that adds depth to the world

WARNING Start a **new save** for Wave 1. Do not load your Wave 0 character with Wave 1 mods. Content mods that add biomes, quests, or NPCs require a fresh universe to generate correctly.

Advanced Strategy

You have beaten the Ruin and seen the credits roll. Now you are back for more — with mods that deepen every system. This chapter covers strategies and knowledge that separate veteran explorers from the rest.

Planet Tier Optimization

Understanding Threat Levels

Every planet has a **threat level** (1-10, shown in the navigation console). Higher threat means:

- Tougher enemies with more health and damage
- Better ore spawns (higher tier)
- Better loot in chests
- Higher chance of rare dungeons and microdungeons

CONCEPT The tier sweet spot: Always fight at your armor tier or one tier above. At-tier fights are comfortable. +1 tier fights are challenging but reward more. +2 tiers will kill you unless you have exceptional weapons and movement tech.

Farming Routes

Once you understand ore tiers, optimize your route:

1. **Iron run (Tier 1):** Any Lush planet. 10 minutes. Get 100+ Iron Ore. Skip caves — surface deposits are faster.
2. **Tungsten run (Tier 2):** Desert planets. Visit the surface merchant for Manipulator Modules.
3. **Titanium run (Tier 3):** Ocean planets. Beam to the ocean floor. Titanium deposits are visible on the seabed.
4. **Durasteel run (Tier 4):** Toxic planets. Bring antidotes. Underground deposits are rich.
5. **Endgame ores:** Visit each racial-tier planet type (Frozen = Aegisalt, Fiery = Ferozium, Radioactive = Violium). For Solarium, farm the core of Fiery planets.

TIP Buy ore from merchants when you have excess pixels. The Ursa Miner (found at outposts) sells ore up to Durasteel tier. It is often faster to farm pixels and buy than to mine.

Faction Dynamics

Your actions affect how NPC factions perceive you. This matters for trade prices, quest availability, and crew recruitment.

- **Protectorate:** Your default faction. Reputation increases through story progression.
- **Peacekeepers:** Bounty hunting faction. Increases as you complete bounties.
- **Settlements:** Local reputation per-planet. Completing quests for a settlement improves prices and sometimes unlocks unique crew members.

CONCEPT Reputation decay: If you attack a settlement, reputation with that faction drops and takes multiple quests to recover. Do not test weapons near friendly NPCs.

Crew Composition

A ship with 12 crew members has maximum passive bonuses. Optimize your composition:

| Role | Priority | Why | |——|———|——| | Engineer | 3-4 | Fuel efficiency stacks. More engineers = longer jumps. | | Soldier | 2 | Follows you planetside. Useful for body-blocking in combat. | | Medic | 2 | Health regen stacks. Two medics make you nearly unkillable between fights. | | Mechanic | 1 | Ship speed bonus. One is enough. | | Janitor | 1 | Minor all-around boost. | | Tailor | 1 | For uniform customization. Purely cosmetic. |

TIP Recruit crew from **friendly** settlements. Hostile or neutral NPCs will not join. Look for NPCs with exclamation marks — they always offer a quest and may join afterward.

Base Building Efficiency

Location Selection

Your primary base should be on a planet that is:

- **Safe:** No meteor showers, no acid rain, no hostile NPC patrols
- **Rich:** Near surface ore deposits for passive resource collection
- **Accessible:** Bookmark the planet as a teleport destination

Lush planets at threat level 1-3 are ideal. They have mild weather, friendly settlements, and no environmental hazards.

Defensive Design

- Build your base off the ground (pillars or a floating platform) to prevent ground NPCs from wandering in
- Place **Turrets** (crafted at a Wiring Station) at entrances
- Light everything — enemies do not spawn in well-lit areas
- Keep a **Teleporter** and a **Flag** for quick return

Colony Optimization

CONCEPT Tenant spawning: The game checks each valid room once per in-game day. If a room meets the requirements for multiple tenant types, it picks one randomly. To guarantee a specific tenant, make each room meet exactly one set of requirements.

High-value tenants:

- **Chef** (Cooking Table): Buys crops at premium prices. Passive food income.
- **Guard** (Weapon Rack): Defends your colony from wildlife.
- **Merchant** (Cash Register): Sells random rare items. Worth checking daily.

Rare Resources

| Resource | Location | Use | |———|———|——| | Upgrade Modules | Planet chests, quest rewards | Improve crafted gear stats | | Manipulator Modules | Surface chests, merchants | Matter Manipulator upgrades | | Tech Cards | Tech Chests (story dungeons) | Unlock new techs | | Diamonds | Deep caves, Volcanic planets | High pixel value, crafting | | Venus Crystals | Toxic planets (surface) | Advanced crafting | | Ancient Essence | Vaults (post-game) | Terraforming, endgame crafting |

TIP Manipulator Modules are the bottleneck. Buy them from every merchant you meet. You need a total of 10 for a fully upgraded Matter Manipulator.

Boss Tactics

Ixodoom (Floran Mission)

- **Phase 1:** Dodge the charge. Attack from behind.
- **Phase 2:** Spawns smaller Ixolings. Kill them first — they overwhelm quickly.
- **Weapon:** Ranged. Do not melee the Ixodoom.

Asra Nox Encounter (Hylotl Mission)

- This is a **chase**, not a fight. Follow her, dodge the energy blasts, survive.
- You will face her properly later in the story.

Kluex Avatar (Avian Mission)

- **Arena:** Temple chamber with pillars. Use pillars for cover.
- **Attack pattern:** Energy orbs (dodge vertically), ground slam (jump over shockwave).
- **Weapon:** Ranged with high DPS. The fight is a damage race.

Big Ape (Apex Mission)

- **Arena:** Multi-level lab. Stay on the lower level — Big Ape destroys upper platforms.
- **Attack pattern:** Lasers from eyes, ground pounds, minigun sweep.
- **Tactic:** Circle-strafe and fire. Shield tech helps.

Bone Dragon (Glitch Mission)

- **Arena:** Castle courtyard. Open space.
- **Attack pattern:** Fire breath (wide cone), tail swipe (close range).
- **Tactic:** Stay behind its head. Melee the neck.

The Ruin (Final Boss)

- **Phase 1:** Destroy the tentacles. Ignore the heart.
- **Phase 2:** Heart opens. Dump all damage. Use your strongest weapon.
- **Phase 3:** Heart closes again. Repeat phases 1-2.
- **Weapon:** Highest DPS you have. Craft or buy the best available.

Modded Mechanics Integration

Wave 1 mods add systems on top of vanilla. A few principles for navigating them:

1. **Read the mod descriptions.** Each mod entry in this guide includes a “System Impact” badge. Pay attention to it.
2. **Test in isolation.** When a mod adds a new crafting chain or tech tree, try it out before integrating it with other systems. Some mods change the same vanilla system and need load order tweaking.
3. **Check the install notes.** Each mod entry includes SBMM-specific guidance. Follow it.
4. **Expect depth.** Modded mechanics are designed for players who have already mastered vanilla. They assume you know how crafting, tech, and ship systems work.
5. **Back up before big changes.** If you add a major mechanics mod mid-playthrough (not recommended, but sometimes done), back up your save first.

WARNING Adding or removing mechanics mods on an existing save is risky. Missing items, broken crafting recipes, and world generation issues are common. The safest approach: finalize your Wave 1 mod list before starting the playthrough, and do not change it mid-game.

Wave 1 Modlist

Graphics

Mods go here.

Races

Mods go here.

Content

Mods go here.

Mechanics

Mods go here.

Ships

Mods go here.

Weapons and Armor

Mods go here.

Building

Mods go here.

Audio

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Adult

Mods go here.